

TIMELINE 1863

Emancipation Proclamation ■ **River operations in Arkansas, Mississippi, and Louisiana** ■ Battle of Chancellorsville ■ **Siege of Vicksburg** ■ Combahee River raid ■ **Gettysburg** ■ Chickamauga Campaign ■ **Chattanooga Campaign** ■ Gettysburg Address

“But this war goes **on and on**, and the **men die**, and the **price gets ever higher** ... We are adrift here in a sea of blood and ... I want this to be the **final battle.**”

GENERAL ROBERT E. LEE, BATTLE OF GETTYSBURG, JULY 2, 1863

JANUARY	FEBRUARY	MARCH	APRIL	MAY	JUNE	JULY	AUGUST	SEPTEMBER	OCTOBER	NOVEMBER	DECEMBER
		MARCH 3 The U.S. Congress passes the Corwin Act, though in practice this does less to boost Union recruitment than its supporters hoped.	APRIL 7 Admiral Samuel F. DuRoi leads an unsuccessful Union naval assault on Charleston, South Carolina.	MAY 1 The Confederate Congress resolves to punish white Union officers captured while commanding black units.		JULY 1 Bragg's Confederate forces withdraw from Tullahoma toward Chattanooga in Tennessee.	AUGUST 8 Lee offers President Davis his resignation, but Davis refuses to accept it.	SEPTEMBER 2 Ambrose Burnside's Union Army of the Ohio occupies Knoxville, Tennessee.	OCTOBER 2 The Union Army of the Cumberland under Rosecrans is short of supplies and besieged at Chattanooga.		DECEMBER 3 As Union reinforcements approach Knoxville, Longstreet abandons the Confederate siege.
JANUARY 1 President Lincoln issues the final version of the Emancipation Proclamation, announcing the freeing of all enslaved people in states that seceded.	FEBRUARY 1 Union troops capture Franklin, Tennessee.			MAY 1 Battle of Port Gibson. Grant's troops defeat Confederate forces on the eastern bank of the Mississippi River.			AUGUST 16 General William S. Rosecrans's Union Army of the Cumberland begins an advance from Chattanooga to attack Bragg's Army of Tennessee around Chattanooga.	SEPTEMBER 5 The British government detains the two "Land Rams," warships being built for the Confederate Navy.	OCTOBER 5 The Confederates make a damaging attack on the USS Albatross, New Knoxville of Charleston, South Carolina.	NOVEMBER 4 The Confederates weaken their forces around Chattanooga by sending troops to the Knoxville area.	
JANUARY 3 Battle of Stones River (Murfreesboro), Tennessee. Early on December 31, 1862, Union troops defeat General Bragg's Confederate forces.	FEBRUARY 3-20 Operations on the Union River, Arkansas. Union troops fail to capture Vicksburg, Mississippi, using the river system to the city's north and west.	A Union gunboat sinks the USS Hartford.		APRIL 16-17 Union gunboats capture Vicksburg in a daring night move. General William S. Rosecrans's army is mortally wounded.	MAY 1-6 Battle of Chancellorsville. Although outnumbered, General Robert E. Lee outmaneuvers General Union army.	JUNE 1-2 Harriet Tubman helps Union troops in the Combahee River raid in South Carolina.		SEPTEMBER 7 General Rosecrans orders Chattanooga, on their advance in Tennessee.	OCTOBER 17 Grant is prepared to command all Union forces in the South. Threatens the appoints General Sherman to replace Rosecrans.		
				M The Battle of Chancellorsville.	A Harriet Tubman	A The Battle of Gettysburg.	AUGUST 17 Union batteries begin a major bombardment of Fort Sumter in Charleston harbor on the South Carolina coast.	SEPTEMBER 19-20 Battle of Chickamauga. Bragg's Confederate forces defeat the Army of the Cumberland under Rosecrans, ending the Union's Chickamauga Campaign in Georgia.	M Union V. Grant	NOVEMBER 19 President Lincoln delivers the Gettysburg Address at the dedication of a national memorial cemetery.	DECEMBER 8 In his annual message to Congress, President Lincoln outlines plans for the reconstruction of the South. Most Confederates are to receive amnesty and have all property except enslaved people restored.
JANUARY 11 The USS Albatross sinks the USS Hatteras off Galveston, Texas. Fort Hindman, Arkansas, is captured by Union forces.	FEBRUARY 5 Brain announces that it will not attempt to retake between the North and South.	MARCH 5 Confederate forces take Franklin, Tennessee.									
JANUARY 24 General Joseph Hooker is appointed to command the Union Army of the Potomac, succeeding General Ambrose Burnside.		MARCH 14 Part of Admiral David G. Farragut's Union squadron succeeds in getting past Port Hudson, Louisiana, after which it will be a three-week raid through Mississippi and Louisiana to Baton Rouge, distracting Confederate generals from the growing threat to Vicksburg.	APRIL 17 Colonel Benjamin Grimes leads Union cavalry from La Grange, Tennessee, on what will be a three-week raid through Mississippi and Louisiana to Baton Rouge, distracting Confederate generals from the growing threat to Vicksburg.	MAY 6-17 The main body of Lee's Army of Northern Virginia begins to leave the Fredericksburg area to what will become the Gettysburg campaign.	JUNE 3 The main body of Lee's Army of Northern Virginia begins to leave the Fredericksburg area to what will become the Gettysburg campaign.	JULY 4 Confederate forces surrender Vicksburg.				NOVEMBER 28 In Dalton, Georgia, Braxton Bragg takes up the resignation to President Davis.	DECEMBER 16 General Joseph E. Johnston is given command of the Confederate Army of Tennessee, and General Leonidas Polk takes charge of the Army of Mississippi.